

My Working Direction

Step 1 · Picture · Anna · 9 October 2026

What you want to explore, what you take with you, and your next step.

My life picture in three sentences

I want to wake with the light in a small house with land, and work three mornings a week at the bookkeeping I am good at. I want two hours outside every day and people close enough to eat with. I want to stop being afraid of January.

What I choose now

A direction to investigate

The direction(s) I want to explore

Renting a small house with land inland from Coimbra, around Góis or Arganil, for a year before buying anything.

Why: two or three reasons

It meets every essential I wrote down. It is reversible, so a wrong answer costs me a year and not my savings. And the money check says I can carry the gap for about three years, which is long enough to find out properly.

My essential needs: I take these with me

Outside space of my own. Internet I can work on. A doctor within half an hour. A day's travel to my sister. Neighbours.

Assumptions I still need to check

That the internet is good enough to keep my clients. That €780 really rents a house with land. That I can bear February there alone. That my clients do not mind the address.

What I need to learn next

What a winter inland is actually like. Real monthly figures from two people who live there. What the residency paperwork takes, in weeks.

What I am willing to invest: time, money, comfort

The office salary, €1,250 a month. The car. Two hours a week on Portuguese. Being near my sister every Sunday. I am not willing to give up my reserve of €8,000.

Who can help me

My sister Lotte, Rui and Ineke in Góis, my oldest client Hendrik

The first question I will investigate, and why it matters most

Can I work from there to the standard my clients pay for? It matters most because every other part of the plan rests on that €1,650 continuing.

My next small step, within two weeks

Book six weeks inland in February and ask for Thursdays at home

What this step will help me learn

Whether the winter, the internet and the quiet are real or imagined

Date of this step

20 October 2026

When I will review what I learned

The first week of April 2027, after the six weeks

What result would make me continue, change direction, or stop

Continue if I can work two full weeks from there without a single apology to a client, and if February does not frighten me. Change direction if the internet fails. Stop if six weeks alone there makes me lonely rather than quiet.

In two years, how I will know this worked

I will know it worked if I am outside two hours a day, if January 2029 does not frighten me, and if someone in the village knows how I take my coffee.

The people involved

PERSON	SHARED WISHES	WHERE WE DIFFER	OPEN CONCERNS	WHAT WE AGREED
Lotte, my sister	That I should stop postponing this	She wants me a day's drive away, not a flight	Who is here if our mother gets worse	I come back three times a year, dates fixed in advance
Hendrik, my oldest client	The work matters, the address does not	He wants one week a year in person	Response time in his busy month	I fly over in March every year, at my own cost

You have made your picture clearer, looked honestly at your life and your money, and chosen a Working Direction.

You cannot control everything. But you can choose, prepare, and take the next step.

You just took the first one.